Customer Complaint Handling Manual

Document ID: EN-MAN-04 **Department:** Customer Service **Version:** 2.1 **Effective Date:** 1 February 2026

1. Purpose

This manual provides Customer Service staff with a consistent process for receiving, investigating, and resolving customer complaints in a fair and timely manner.

2. Complaint Channels

2.1 Customers may submit complaints through the Company website contact form, by telephone to the Customer Service Helpline, by email, or in writing to the registered head office address.

2.2 All complaints, regardless of channel, must be logged in the Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system within one working day of receipt.

3. Initial Response

3.1 Customers must receive an acknowledgement of their complaint within 24 hours, confirming receipt and providing a unique complaint reference number.

3.2 The acknowledgement should set expectations for the investigation timeline: five working days for straightforward complaints, or up to fifteen working days for complaints requiring investigation across multiple departments.

4. Investigation

4.1 The assigned Customer Service Representative must review all relevant order, delivery, and communication records related to the complaint before contacting the customer for resolution.

4.2 Complaints involving potential product safety issues must be escalated immediately to the Quality Assurance team, regardless of the standard timeline in Section 3.2.

5. Resolution and Compensation

5.1 Representatives are authorised to offer resolutions up to £100 in value (refund, replacement, or goodwill credit) without further approval. Resolutions exceeding this value require Team Leader sign-off.

5.2 All resolutions offered must be recorded in the CRM system, including the reasoning for the resolution chosen.

6. Escalation

6.1 Complaints unresolved after the standard timeline, or where the customer remains dissatisfied with the proposed resolution, must be escalated to the Customer Service Team Leader, and if unresolved thereafter, to the Head of Customer Experience.

7. Recurring Issues

7.1 The Customer Service Team Leader reviews complaint data monthly to identify recurring product, delivery, or service issues, and reports significant trends to the relevant department head and the Quality Assurance team.

8. Related Documents

- Data Protection and Privacy Policy (EN-POL-04) — for handling of customer personal data during investigations

9. Approval

Approved by the Head of Customer Experience on 10 January 2026.